

Chapter 127-3

Xu Qingzhu opened her mouth wanting to speak, but stopped.

After several attempts, she finally spoke her first sentence: "How long has she been unconscious?"

Her cool, clear voice was choked with emotion.

Zhao Xuning answered coldly: "Three days. A full body examination has been done—there are no obvious abnormalities."

"Then will she still come back?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Zhao Xuning's pupils contracted slightly, startled by her words. Then she said with certainty: "She will."

But after saying it, she felt a bit uncertain—she wasn't sure either.

This was Liang Shi's secret, known only to the two of them.

Zhao Xuning didn't know why Xu Qingzhu immediately asked if Liang Shi would "come back" rather than "wake up."

At the time, Zhao Xuning hadn't thought of this issue either. She was inclined to explain everything through medicine, so she had stayed up all night with the department head researching the reason for Liang Shi's continued unconsciousness.

She had even made overseas calls to authorities in this field, but received no answers.

It was only when medicine couldn't explain it that Zhao Xuning thought of those things Liang Shi had mentioned before—though she hadn't fully believed them.

But unexpectedly, Xu Qingzhu had immediately asked this question.

Zhao Xuning couldn't discuss it with her right now.

After asking this question, Xu Qingzhu also fell quiet.

She seemed to only be searching for a point—a point that could help her stand up and support herself.

After a long silence, she suddenly asked coldly: "What about Chen Liuying?"

Zhao Xuning: "Hm?"

"Dr. Gu." Xu Qingzhu raised her head to look at Gu Junru. She licked her lips. "I... let's talk."

Gu Junru was pleasantly surprised: "Alright."

After saying this, Xu Qingzhu slowly bent down.

It was a very slow movement—if placed in a film, it would definitely be a scene beautiful enough to replay multiple times.

Xu Qingzhu closed her eyes, her eyelashes trembling. She brushed the hair by her ear aside, slowly bent down, and her moist lips landed on the back of Liang Shi's hand as tears fell simultaneously.

Liang Shi's fingers instinctively curled, then remained completely still.

After Xu Qingzhu straightened up, her fingers gently brushed across the back of Liang Shi's hand, wiping away the tears on it.

She gritted her teeth, looking at that quiet face on the hospital bed.

The hospital room was so silent that only the slowed breathing could be heard. Xu Qingzhu's fingertips landed on Liang Shi's jaw, tracing lightly across it in a caressing manner.

Tears welled up in Xu Qingzhu's eyes. She opened her mouth several times but couldn't get a single word out.

After a long while, she said in a choked voice: "Jiejie."

The person on the hospital bed didn't respond.

Seeing that she had recovered somewhat, Zhao Xuning beckoned Dr. Gu to wait outside.

The door was closed, sealing off a gentle universe.

In this universe, there were only the two of them.

"This time." Xu Qingzhu's head gently rested beside her, avoiding the area with her hand.

Their heartbeats mingled together. Xu Qingzhu's voice was soft and tender: "It's my turn to protect you."

//

When Liang Shi woke up again, it was evening. The bright and clean hospital room was very quiet.

When she opened her eyes, she saw the white ceiling and the pungent smell of disinfectant.

Having smelled it for so long, she didn't find it too irritating anymore.

She stiffly turned her head. In the distant sky were orange-pink clouds, continuously spreading out. The remaining glow of the setting sun scattered across the city buildings with their towering high-rises—beautiful like an oil painting.

There was no one in the hospital room. After two episodes of unconsciousness, her mind was finally somewhat clear.

The scene before her was so beautiful it seemed to have stepped out of a painting. She had no way of determining where this place was.

The Wang-jie she had seen before seemed like a dream, but reason told her this seemed to be the place where she had lived for many years.

Her throat was dry and hoarse, unable to speak. Her body was also ridiculously stiff—any slight movement made her feel pain all over, as if pulling one hair would affect her whole body.

Liang Shi exerted great effort just to raise her hand, wanting to press the bell on the side of the hospital bed. But just as she raised her hand, the hospital room door was pushed open and familiar voices rang out.

"Can Liang-jie even wake up? I got excited for nothing."

"She can wake up. Just wait a bit longer."

Two voices came through. A moment later, both people exclaimed in surprise simultaneously: "You're awake?!"

Xiao Bai ran out like she had gone crazy, sprinting at the speed of a hundred-meter dash to find Liang Shi's attending physician. Wang Zhaozhao stood there ramrod straight, and after a moment, adjusted the non-prescription glasses she wore as decoration.

Liang Shi and she looked at each other, as if across a century.

Liang Shi closed her eyes briefly, and a tear rolled down.

Her heart was filled with mixed emotions, yet she still managed a stiff smile.

Liang Shi's voice was hoarse and raspy, sounding as if it were being ground by a blunt object as she spoke.

She said: "Wang-jie, I'm back."

—Long time no see.

Wang Zhaozhao let out a soft breath. "Thank goodness."

—Thank goodness you woke up.